

Healthcare and AI Ethics:

The healthcare industry has rapidly expanded in terms of technologies and innovations. AI technology, specifically, has been a rather new introduction into the industry, seeing widespread adoption in hospitals around the world. With these new technologies comes various different ethical concerns, like job displacement for doctors/diagnosticians, privacy and data breach possibilities, or even sentiment about AI replacing human doctors.

One of the main concerns that AI in healthcare creates is the idea of job displacement/replacement. Although there are plenty of doctors needed in the industry, with the introduction of AI technology, some of these jobs are sometimes completely taken over by these systems. Diagnosticians, clinicians, and even some surgeons have been or are soon to be replaced by either robotic systems or AI models that specialize in their field. While this does take away job opportunities for up and coming job seekers, it also opens new ones, specifically ones that pertain to the upkeep and management of these automated systems. For example, Anthropic had recently opened a new unofficial job title that deals with training

others to work effectively with newer AI systems. However, the fact that the original specialized jobs are being replaced should not be overlooked.

Privacy and data security is another concern that arises when AI is implemented into hospitals. Patient data can be leaked unintentionally or intentionally, personal security can be compromised, and data breaches can result in thousands of patients losing access to their hospital records. These AI systems, though seemingly reliable and secure, do contain workarounds that can be exploited by skilled hackers. Data breaches are also possible threats that AI systems pose. The models could potentially leak sensitive information in order to fulfill tasks assigned to them. This information could include names, addresses, hospital records, Social Security numbers, bank/insurance information, and other documents that are highly sensitive. Hospitals need to take into account these easily-overlooked flaws before deploying any AI model into their systems.

Overall sentiment about AI in general is mixed. Some people are skeptical about the widespread adoption of it, while others are fully supportive of the concept. When it comes to hospitals, sentiment is just as mixed as the general public's perception. The entire idea of an AI system replacing human doctors and professionals clashes with job seekers' desire to work. To add fuel to the fire, these

AI systems aren't 100% reliable in some cases. Some could produce errors that could be fatal, in the case of a hospital adopting an intelligence system. A patient not receiving their medication, a robotic surgery being interrupted by a power surge, nurses having to take over when the AI assistant fails. The list for potential hiccups in the adoption of AI systems can continuously grow as technology advances and evolves.

In the end, the rapid rise of AI in healthcare presents a complex blend of opportunity and risk. Its ability to streamline workflows, enhance diagnostic accuracy, and introduce new technical career paths shows clear potential for improving modern medicine. Yet these benefits cannot be separated from the ethical challenges they bring—concerns about job displacement, vulnerabilities in data security, and public unease about relying on machines for life-critical decisions. As hospitals continue integrating AI systems, the industry will need to balance innovation with responsibility, ensuring that technological progress supports—not replaces—the human expertise, judgment, and compassion at the core of healthcare.